

Weapons of Math Destruction

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Corpus priority: Phase 1

Document type: Synthesized RAG source dossier built from publicly available online material

Purpose In This RAG Corpus

- One of the clearest foundations for connecting human judgment flaws to harmful algorithmic systems.
- Directly relevant to fairness, opacity, contestability, and institutional automation.
- Essential for the AI-bias and societal-impact framing of this project.

Key Concepts And Retrieval Tags

- algorithmic_bias
- historical_bias
- proxy_bias
- opaque_models
- feedback_loop_bias
- contestability

Core Learnings

- Scalable models can amplify bias when they are opaque, unregulated, and hard for affected people to contest.
- Algorithmic systems are often presented as objective while embedding choices about data, proxies, optimization, and power.
- High-stakes systems in lending, hiring, policing, education, and insurance can reinforce inequality instead of reducing it.
- The combination of scale, opacity, and weak accountability is especially dangerous in public or quasi-public decision systems.
- The book is valuable because it makes systemic harm concrete and institutionally legible.

Directions, Observations, And Implications

- Use this source whenever the scenario involves automated screening, ranking, recommendation, or risk scoring.
- Retrieve it for discussions of fairness audits, contestability, data proxies, and governance controls.
- Apply it in tandem with human-bias sources to explain how human and model biases can reinforce one another.

How This Can Be Applied In Decision Making

- Use this source whenever the scenario involves automated screening, ranking, recommendation, or risk scoring.
- Retrieve it for discussions of fairness audits, contestability, data proxies, and governance controls.

- Apply it in tandem with human-bias sources to explain how human and model biases can reinforce one another.

How This Strengthens A Bias-Aware RAG System

- Critical for connecting the project's decision-intelligence framing to AI fairness and institutional harm.
- Supports retrieval for hiring models, credit models, search/ranking systems, and public-sector automation.
- Strengthens governance recommendations beyond individual-level bias mitigation.

Limitations And Cautions

- This dossier is synthesized from public descriptions and commentary rather than the full book text.
- The book is intentionally polemical at times, so the RAG system should pair it with complementary governance and technical sources.

Source Notes

- Apple Books publisher description (publisher_description):
<https://books.apple.com/us/book/weapons-of-math-destruction/id1067627008>
- Open Library overview (library_summary):
https://openlibrary.org/works/OL17840708W/Weapons_of_Math_Destruction
- Time interview/profile summary (interview_summary):
<https://time.com/4471451/cathy-oneil-math-destruction/>

RAG Ingestion Note

This document is intentionally written as a concise, retrieval-friendly synthesis rather than as a book review. It is designed to help the system retrieve named biases and decision failures, practical mitigation methods, organizational and AI-governance implications, and scenario-to-concept mappings for user prompts.